HANOVER RESEARCH

ACADEMIC PROGRAM ASSESSMENT

Master's In Public Health

Prepared for Texas Christian University

May 2023

In the following report, Hanover Research (Hanover) assesses demand for master's degree programs in public health, specifically highlighting demand trends from across the nation. This report includes an examination of student and labor market demand, and an analysis of potential competitor programs.

TABLE OF CONTENTS

3 / Executive Summary

5 / Student Demand Analysis

7 / Labor Market Analysis

10 / Program Trends

13 / Competitor Analysis

17 / Program Benchmarking

RECOMMENDATIONS

Based on an analysis of degree completions, labor market demand, and market competitors, Hanover recommends that Texas Christian University (TCU):

LAUNCH A MASTER'S IN PUBLIC HEALTH PROGRAM.

Higher than average student demand and labor demand indicate that a new master's in public health program is viable and has the potential to be successful at the national level. Student demand has grown 3.3 percent annually from 2017 to 2021, which is significantly faster than the national average growth for all fields (1.9 percent). Labor demand for public health-related occupations are projected to grow over twice as fast as the average at all geographic levels, indicating graduates of TCU's program would have a variety of employment opportunities. When developing this program, TCU should prioritize the Council on Education for Public Health (CEPH) accreditation and structure its program to include CEPH public health competencies, applied practice experiences, and integrated learning experiences.

CONSIDER OFFERING BOTH ONLINE AND ON-CAMPUS MODALITIES.

According to IPEDS, the proportion public health master's programs reporting a distance component was nearly 47 percent in 2021. Most benchmarked online master's programs have high degree completions and promising growth rates, suggesting that this delivery format is a viable option. Seven out of nine benchmarked programs offer both on-campus and online programming, indicating that on-campus options are still in demand as well. Offering both modalities would allow TCU to market the flexible options as a strength of the program to prospective students, especially those that are planning to remain in the workforce while completing their degree. Prospective student surveys could also provide insight into which modality formats would be most in demand.

OFFER CONCENTRATIONS, DUAL DEGREE PROGRAMS, AND EXPERIENTIAL LEARNING OPPORTUNITIES

Eight of the nine reviewed programs offer a concentration or specialized track within their public health programs. TCU could implement additional specializations in order to accommodate a wider array of audiences and interests. Common areas of concentration are related to epidemiology, environmental health, health promotion, health policy, and data science. Benchmarked programs offer between one and twelve concentrations each, and seven out of nine benchmarked institutions also offer dual-degree programs. PharmD, JD, and MBA programs are the most common dual programs combined with a MPH. These options would provide additional opportunities for possible joint degree programs outside of a MD/MPH. Providing experiential learning opportunities in the curriculum would also be fundamental and help meet CEPH accreditation requirements. In addition, some programs advertise unique experiential learning and professional development opportunities to differentiate their programs. Exemplar experiences include University of North Texas Health Science Center's required co-curricular professional development programming and the University of Texas Health Science Center at Houston's Dietetic Internship providing experience in public health nutrition.

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

KEY FINDINGS

Student demand for public health master's programs has increased in recent years. Master's completions in public health programs have grown faster than average at the state, regional, and national geographic levels. The Southwest in particular has seen an increase of 8.5 percent from 2017-2021, and conferral volumes have remained relatively high, indicating continually high levels of student interest.

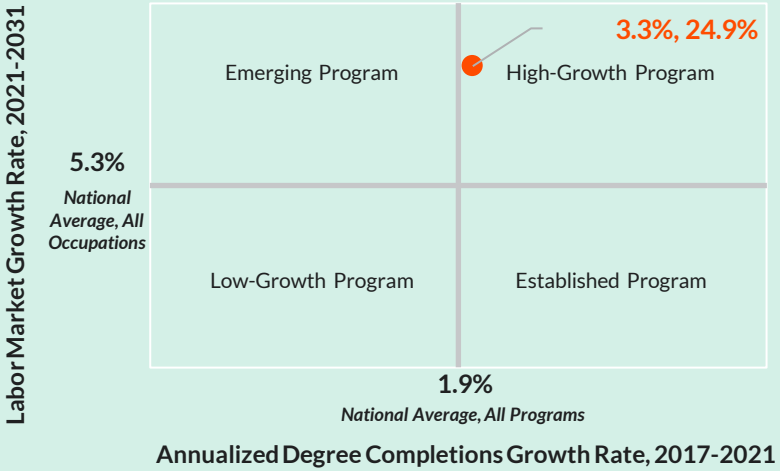
Labor market trends indicate strong employment prospects for public health professionals. At all three geographic levels, public health occupations outpace the overall occupations' average in terms of growth. National job postings indicate over 19,801 job openings in related fields, which provides ample opportunity for graduates to find employment after graduation. Additionally, secondary literature confirms that there will be a continued demand for public health professionals for years to come.

A large portion of master of public health programs offer distance and on-campus learning. From 2017-2021, the number of online health programs has increased, while the volume of all programs have remained high. On-campus programs are still popular, with seven out of the nine reviewed programs offering both online and on-campus formats for their MPH degrees.

Most profiled graduate public health programs allow students to complete concentrations and offer dual degrees. Eight out of nine benchmarked programs offer concentrations. The most common specialization offered among MPH programs is epidemiology, followed by health promotion and behavior. Dual degree programs are also common amongst benchmarked competitors, with seven out of nine institutions offering them. PharmD, JD, and MBA programs are the most common dual programs combined with a MPH.

NATIONAL BENCHMARK ANALYSIS

Comparison of MPH completions and relevant labor market to all completions and all occupations in the country



FAST FACTS

46.6% Percent of MPH programs reporting a distance format to IPEDS

$1,075 Average per credit tuition rate for benchmarked online programs

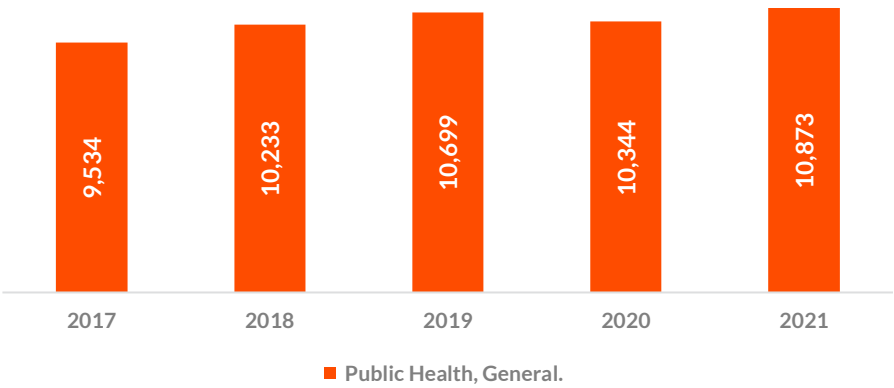
43.5% Projected employment growth for *medical and health services managers* in Texas over the next decade

STUDENT DEMAND ANALYSIS

STUDENT DEMAND ANALYSIS

NATIONAL DEGREE COMPLETIONS

National distribution of degree completions from 2017-2021



TOTAL DEGREE COMPLETIONS

Aggregate degree completions by geographic level (2021)

	Texas	Southwest (AZ, NM, OK, TX)	National
Public Health, General.	262	608	10,873
Growth Rate, Observed Fields	**9.8%**	**8.5%**	**3.3%**
Growth Rate, All Fields	**1.6%**	**3.3%**	**1.9%**

Source: IPEDS

ANALYSIS

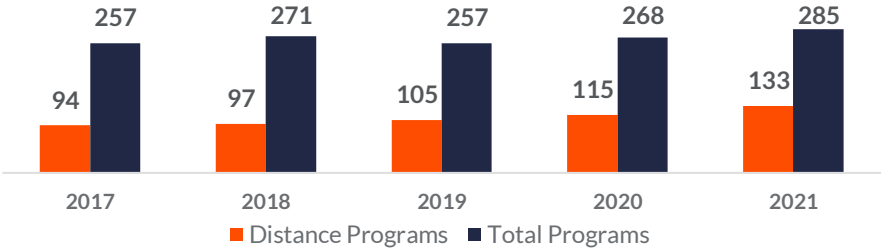
Student demand for master's degrees in public health has experienced above average growth at all geographic levels form 2017-2021. Nationally, public health master's degree completions increased at an annualized rate of 3.3 percent, faster than the 1.9 percent overall completion rate for all master's degrees. Conferral growth is even more promising in Texas (9.8 percent) and the Southwest region (8.5 percent), with growth rates in these areas significantly outpacing overall master's completion rates.

Since the start of the COVID-19 pandemic, student interest in public health programs has grown substantially. In 2020, applications to public health master's programs increased by 20 percent according to the Association of Schools and Programs of Public Health. A report from GovTech suggests this trend has continued throughout the pandemic.

Online MPH delivery has become increasingly popular over the years. Programs reporting to IPEDs as having an online component make up nearly 47 percent of the nation's total MPH programs, where a larger portion of non-traditional students and working professionals can enroll in public health programs at this level.

NATIONAL ONLINE PROGRAMS

National online MPH programs offered from 2017-2021

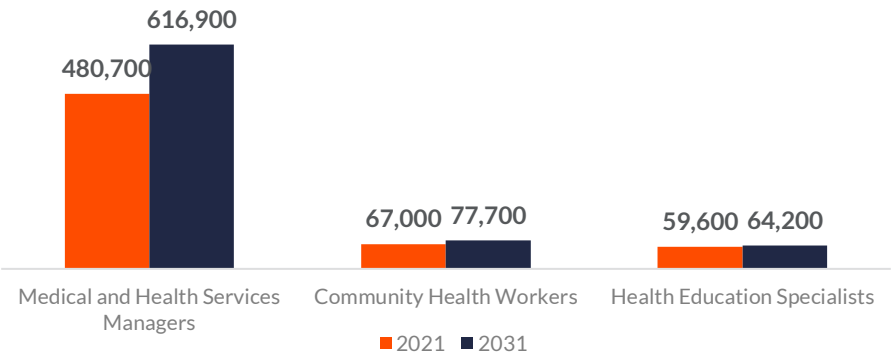


LABOR MARKET ANALYSIS

LABOR MARKET ANALYSIS

NATIONAL CURRENT AND PROJECTED EMPLOYMENT

National public health-related positions as of 2021 and 2031 (projected)



TOTAL LABOR MARKET

Aggregate projected employment growth by geographic level

	Texas	Southwest	National
Estimated Employment (2021)	46,989	69,487	607,300
Projected Employment (2031)	65,944	95,914	758,800
Total Annual Openings, Observed Occupations	**6,357**	**9,218**	**72,500**
Employment Growth, Observed Occupations	**40.3%**	**38.0%**	**24.9%**
Employment Growth, All Occupations	**17.6%**	**16.0%**	**5.3%**

Sources: JobsEQ and BLS
Note: State and regional employment data come from JobsEQ and reflect the period from 2022 to 2032, whereas national data come from the BLS and reflect the period from 2021 to 2031.

ANALYSIS

Graduates of public health doctoral programs will have promising employment prospects at all geographic levels over the next decade. Between 2021 and 2031, the national labor market for public health-related occupations is projected to increase by 24.9 percent, which is much faster than the expected average of 5.3 percent for all occupations. Texas is even more promising with a 40.3 percent projected growth rate.

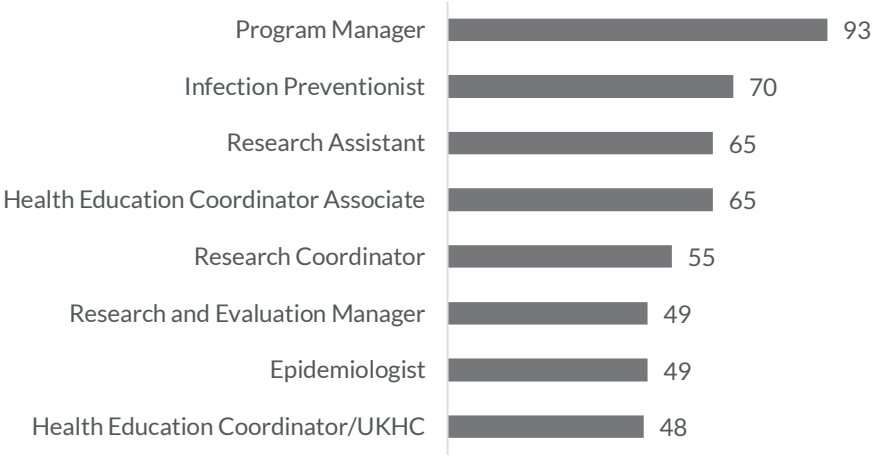
The aging baby-boomer population and COVID-19 pandemic has led to an increasing demand for new public health jobs across the country. The Bureau of Labor Statistics highlights that there is an increasing demand for healthcare services as the large baby-boom population enters older age groups, which typically experience more health problems. *Medical and Health Services Managers* will be needed to organize and oversee medical information and healthcare staff and improve care coordination. Additionally, the shortage of public health experts has been keenly felt in the struggle against COVID-19. Epidemiologists and other public health workers throughout the country were among the first responders to the health challenges of COVID-19. Thus, the recent American Rescue Plan includes $7.66 billion "to establish, expand, and sustain a public health workforce" in state, territorial, and local health departments

Employment of *medical and health services managers* is particularly strong in Texas. Projected employment growth for *medical and health services managers* is the highest among all examined occupations in the state (43.5 percent), in the Southwest region (41.7 percent), and the nation (28.3 percent). In addition, according to the BLS, Texas has the second highest employment volume of *medical and health services managers* in the nation when compared to other states. Typically, these positions require workers to have a bachelor's degree before entering the field, though master's degrees are also common.

REAL-TIME JOB POSTINGS INTELLIGENCE

TOP PUBLIC HEALTH-RELATED JOB TITLES

National public health-related positions by job title



TOP CREDENTIALS AND SKILLS

Top Certifications

- Registered Nurse (RN)
- Certification in Cardiopulmonary Resuscitation (CPR)
- Licensed Practical Nurse (LPN)
- Basic Life Support (BLS)
- Certified Health Education Specialist (CHES)
- Certified Professional in Healthcare Quality (CPHQ)
- Project Management Professional (PMP)

Top Hard Skills

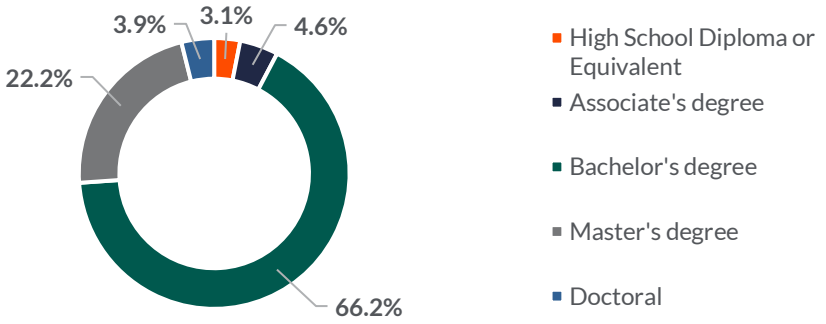
- Public Health
- Microsoft Excel
- Microsoft Office
- Microsoft PowerPoint
- Data Analysis
- Microsoft Outlook
- Microsoft Word
- Statistical Analysis System (SAS)
- Statistics
- Spanish
- Presentation

Note: For this analysis, Hanover retrieved job postings data for public health-related positions in the nation from JobsEQ, a proprietary database providing real-time job postings aggregated from thousands of websites. All data reflect the prior six-month period as of April 2023.

ANALYSIS

National job ads show that there are several career paths and employment opportunities in public health, although bachelor's degrees are more commonly required for these positions. In total, 19,801 job ads have been posted in the last six months for public health-related occupations. Of these, approximately 22.2 percent of postings specifically require a master's degree. Most public health related job ads require or prefer applicants to have a bachelor's degree (66.2 percent).

EDUCATION REQUIREMENTS



Note: 1,032 listings did not specify educational attainment requirements.

TOP NATIONAL EMPLOYERS

- ICF
- United Health Group
- State of Washington
- Oklahoma State Department of Health
- State of Colorado
- Molina Healthcare
- American Heart Association
- Texas Dept of State Health Services
- Elevance Health

PROGRAM TRENDS

ACCREDITATION REQUIREMENTS

ANALYSIS

The Council on Education for Public Health (CEPH) is the primary accreditor of public health schools and programs. CEPH's mission is to "[assure] quality in public health education and training to achieve excellence in practice, research and service, through collaboration with organizational and community partners." As of 2021, CEPH accredits 68 schools of public health, 136 standalone graduate programs, and 20 standalone baccalaureate programs. Additionally, 52 public health schools and programs are currently seeking accreditation from CEPH.

All CEPH-accredited public health programs must employ at least three faculty members per specialization area for the first degree level offered (e.g., "a concentration offering bachelor's and master's degrees OR master's and doctoral degrees requires four faculty members"). Within each concentration, programs must have two primary instructional faculty members and one faculty member "of any type (faculty from another university unit, adjunct faculty, part-time faculty or primary instructional faculty associated with another concentration area)." Primary faculty members must be employed full-time, and all faculty members must have education and experience "appropriate for the degree level (bachelor's, master's, doctoral) and the nature of the degree (research, professional practice, etc.) with which they are associated." A CEPH-accreditated public health program requires a minimum of three primary instructional faculty regardless of the number of concentrations.

CEPH places a significant emphasis on diversity and cultural competence. Accredited programs must "[define] systematic, coherent and long-term efforts to incorporate elements of diversity." CEPH states that programs may promote diversity and cultural competence through:

- "Incorporation of diversity and cultural competency considerations in the curriculum"
- "Recruitment and retention of diverse faculty, staff and students"
- "Development and/or implementation of policies that support a climate of equity and inclusion, free of harassment and discrimination"
- "Reflection of diversity and cultural competence in the types of scholarships and/or community engagement conducted"

SAMPLE OF MPH-RELEVANT ACCREDITATION CRITERIA

MPH & DrPH Foundational Public Health Knowledge

"The school or program ensures that all MPH and DrPH graduates are grounded in foundational public health knowledge."

MPH Foundational Competencies

"All MPH graduates demonstrate the following competencies:" Evidence-based Approaches to Public Health, Public Health & Health Care Systems, Planning & Management to Promote Health, Policy in Public Health, Leadership, Communication, Interprofessional Practice, and Systems Thinking.

MPH & DrPH Concentration Competencies

"The school or program defines at least five distinct competencies for each concentration or generalist degree at each degree level."

MPH Applied Practice Experiences

"MPH students demonstrate competency attainment through applied practice experiences. Applied practice experiences may be concentrated in time or may be spread throughout a student's enrollment."

MPH Integrative Learning Experience

"MPH students complete an integrative learning experience (ILE) that demonstrates synthesis of foundational and concentration competencies. Students in consultation with faculty select foundational and concentration-specific competencies appropriate to the student's educational and professional goals."

MPH Program Length

"An MPH degree requires at least 42 semester-credits, 56 quarter-credits or the equivalent for completion."

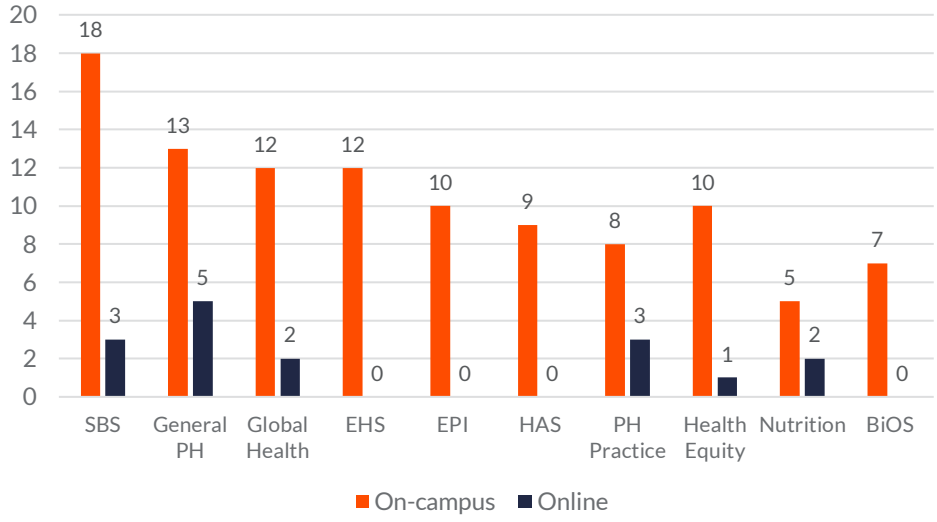
Source: CEPH

CONCENTRATIONS TRENDS

According to the CEPH, general public health was the second-fastest growing concentration from 2017-2019, with social and behavioral sciences concentrations growing the fastest. Offering multiple concentrations within MPH programs is common, although programs are not required to offer concentrations, and some (like Lenoir-Rhyne University) offer just one. 75 CEPH-accredited universities offer a general public health concentration in their MPH degree.

In accreditated online programs, concentrations in social and behavioral science, general public health, and health services administration are the most popular. CEPH notes that between 2017-2019, no institutions dropped distance learning modalities while still retaining on-campus programs.

MPH Concentration Offerings Added from 2017-2019**



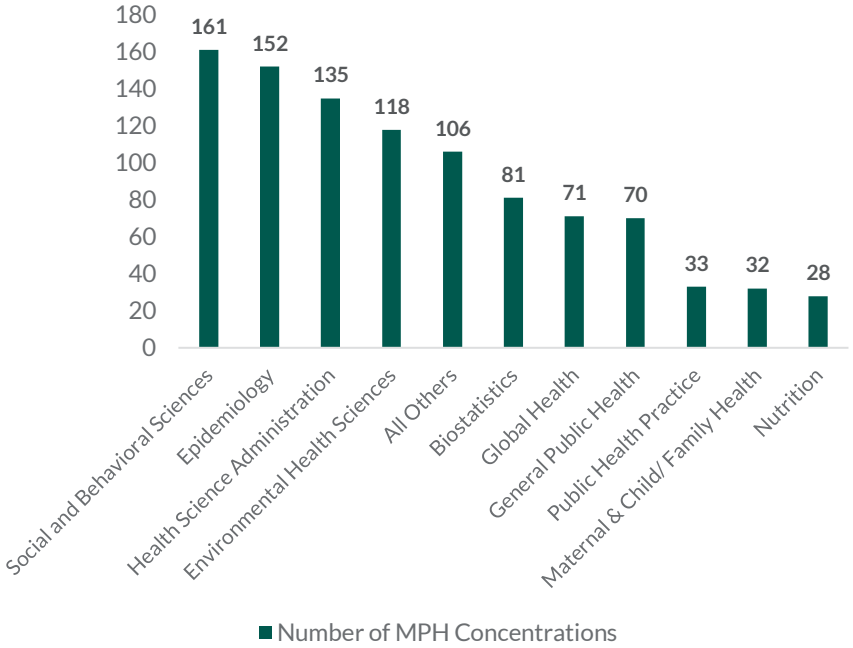
**12 concentration offerings are counted in two categories, e.g., global health equity. Concentrations from the same unit offered in multiple modalities are counted in both the on-campus and online bars.

Source: The figure above is adapted from a similar image that appears in CEPH Trends 2020: MPH Concentrations.

Note: SBS=Social & Behavioral Science; EHS = Environmental Health Sciences, EPI= Epidemiology, HSA = Health Services Administration, BIOS = Biostatistics.

Examples of Social & Behavioral Sciences concentrations include community health, health education & wellness coaching, and health promotion & disease prevention.

Concentration Breakdown CEPH-Accredited Programs: 2019



Data Source: CEPH Trends 2020: MPH Concentrations

Note: Figure presents the concentration breakdown for 194 CEPH-accredited public health schools and programs.

COMPETITOR ANALYSIS

COMPETITOR ANALYSIS

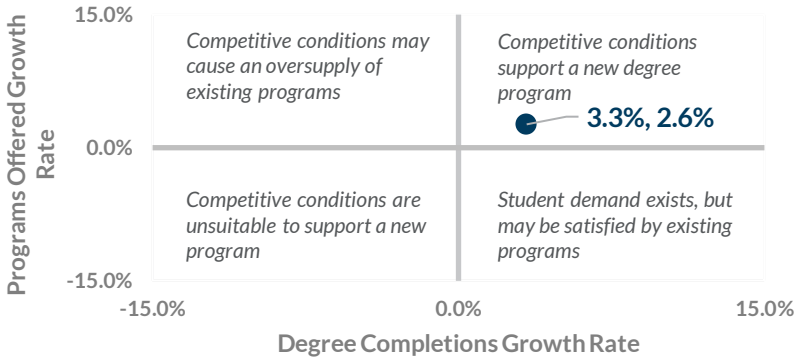
ANALYSIS

The national market supports the addition of another master's in public health program. From 2017 to 2021, the total number of public health master's conferrals grew faster than the number of programs offered in the nation. These trends indicate that institutions are developing new master's programs in public health in response to increasing student demand.

Most benchmarked MPH programs have strong conferral volumes and promising growth rates. To provide a more detailed overview of the competitive landscape, Hanover reviewed nine master's in public health programs at institutions located in Texas, as well as at institutions from across the nation that offer distance formats. Trends from these programs are summarized on slides 15 through 16 , while more details can be found in the benchmarking tables on slides 18 through 21.

NATIONAL MARKET SATURATION

Within the nation do competitive conditions support an additional public health master's program?



BENCHMARKED COMPETITOR PROGRAMS

Institution	State	Program	2021 Degree Conferrals	CAGR
A T Still University of Health Sciences	MO	Master of Public Health (MPH)	107	11.6%
Baylor University	TX	Master of Public Health (MPH)	55	49.5%
Benedictine University	IL	Master of Public Health (MPH)	321	10.2%
Texas Tech University Health Sciences Center	TX	Master of Public Health (MPH)	48	23.0%
The University of Texas at El Paso	TX	Master of Public Health (MPH)	8	-11.4%
The University of Texas Health Science Center at Houston	TX	Master of Public Health (MPH)	106	1.0%
University of Arizona	AZ	Master of Public Health (MPH)	193	8.4%
University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill	NC	Master of Public Health (MPH)	299	39.0%
University of North Texas Health Science Center	TX	Master of Public Health (MPH)	48	11.6%

Source: IPEDS. All programs report to the 51.2201. *Public Health, General* except for Baylor University who uses 51.2207. *Public Health Education and Promotion.*

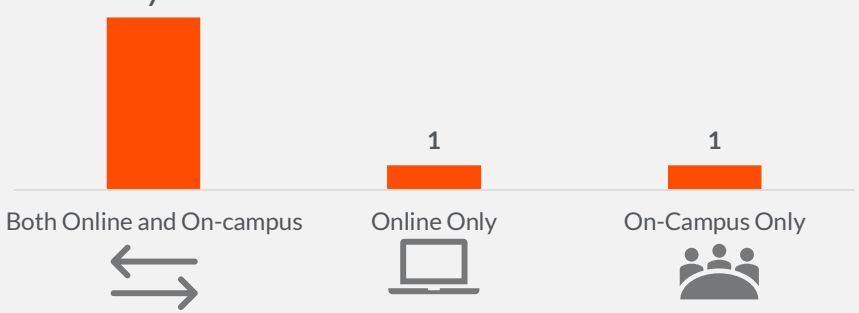
PROGRAM TRENDS

SPECIALIZATIONS

Eight out of nine benchmarked MPH programs allow specializations. Commonly offered specializations (by number of programs) include:

- 6 Epidemiology
- 4 Environmental Health
- 5 Health Promotion or Behavior
- 4 Health Policy and Management
- 4 Biostatistics and Data Science/Analytics

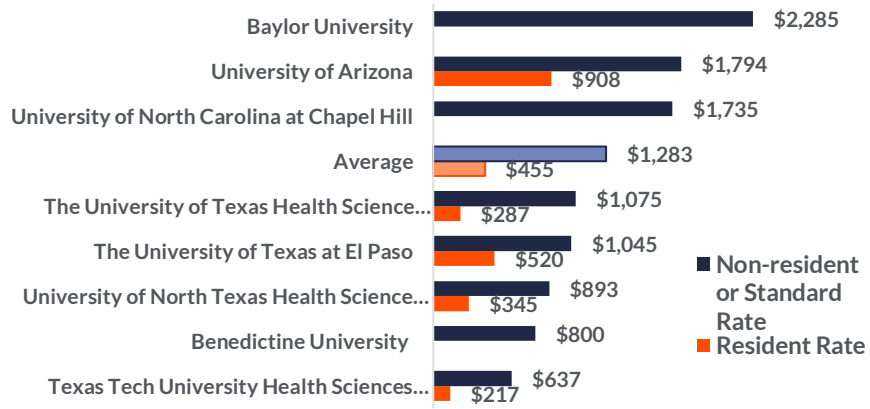
DELIVERY FORMAT



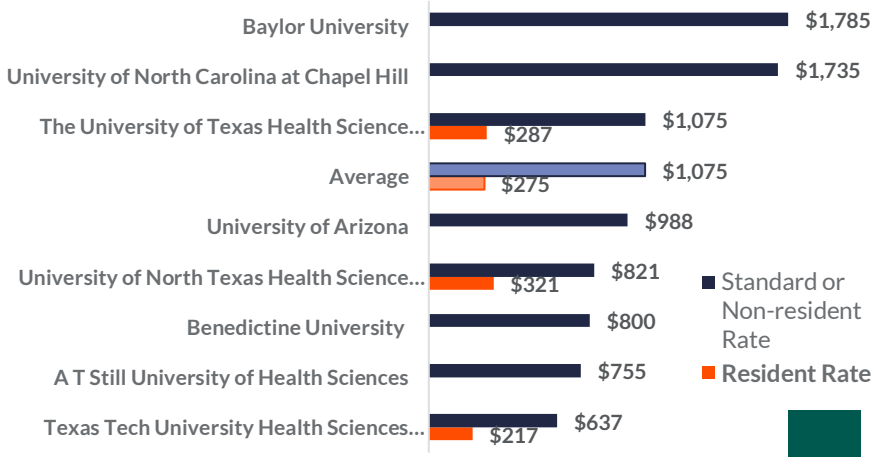
(PER-CREDIT) TUITION

Tuition varies between online and on-campus programs as some institutions over lower tuition rates for their online programs. If TCU develops a MPH program, a tuition rate around or lower than the average $1,283 per credit will be competitive for a standard on-campus rate, while $1,075 would be competitive for an online rate.

ON-CAMPUS RATES



ONLINE RATES



PROGRAM TRENDS

NOTABLE PROGRAMS AND FEATURES

Some benchmarked programs offer opportunities or specialization areas not common amongst competitors.

Certificate Opportunities

- **A T Still University of Health Sciences** offers students to transfer up to 12 credits from their Certificate in Public Health Workforce and Certificate in Public Health, Emergency Preparedness & Disaster Response.
- **Benedictine University** allows MPH students to either earn one of four graduate certificates to fulfill a concentration.

Professional Development and Experiential Learning

- **Texas Tech University Health Sciences Center** allows students to choose between four alternative integrated learning experiences including a thesis, public health project, comprehensive exam, or capstone course.
- **The University of Texas Health Science Center at Houston** offers a Dietetic Internship for students to further specialize in public health nutrition.
- **University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill** MPH core curriculum includes semester-long projects, developing creative, research-based solutions for real-world public health problems.
- **University of North Texas Health Science Center** requires students to participate in 4 hours of co-curricular professional development programming each 8-week session.

Diversity and Global Opportunities

- **University of Arizona** offers study abroad programs tailored to public health or complete the program at a partner university in Ajman, United Arab Emirate.
- **The University of Texas at El Paso's** program places a special emphasis on the promotion of health equity in Hispanic and border communities.

DUAL DEGREES

Professional degrees in pharmacy, law, and business administration are the most common dual degree offerings amongst benchmarked MPH programs. Dual degree offerings are summarized below.

PROGRAM BENCHMARKING

PROGRAM BENCHMARKING

Benchmarked programs are offered by institutions located in the nation. Hanover selected half of programs based on their location in Texas and the rest from well performing distance programs in the country. Institutions are listed in alphabetical order.

Institution	Program	Concentrations	Per-credit Tuition	Delivery Mode	Dual Degrees Offered	Notable Features
A T Still University of Health Sciences	Master of Public Health (MPH)	--	$755	Online	Master of Public Health - Dental Emphasis with a Dental Public Health Residency Certificate	▪ The Public Health Department also offers a Certificate in Public Health Workforce and Certificate in Public Health, Emergency Preparedness & Disaster Response. Those who go on to complete the full MPH may transfer in up to 12 credits from the completed certificate.
Baylor University	Master of Public Health (MPH)	• Community Health Science (online and on-campus) • Environmental Health Sciences (on-campus only) • Epidemiology (on-campus only)	Online MPH: $1,785 On-campus MPH: $2,285	Online and On-campus	--	▪ The Department of Public Health offers Graduate Student Employee (assistantship) positions and academic scholarships for qualified and selected applicants.
Benedictine University	**Master of Public Health (MPH)**	▪ Health Management and Policy ▪ Health Education and Promotion ▪ Data Analytics ▪ Epidemiology ▪ Customized option	$800	Online and On-campus	• Master of Public Health (MPH)/Management and Organizational Behavior (M.S.) • Master of Public Health (MPH)/Master of Business Administration (MBA)	▪ Students can either earn one of four graduate certificates for a concentration or make a customized course of study. Graduate certificate students can apply their credits to the MPH if they choose to continue.

Sources: Institutional websites (see embedded hyperlinks)

PROGRAM BENCHMARKING

Benchmarked programs are offered by institutions located in the nation. Hanover selected half of programs based on their location in Texas and the rest from well performing distance programs in the country. Institutions are listed in alphabetical order.

Institution	Program	Concentrations	Per-credit Tuition	Delivery Mode	Dual Degrees Offered	Notable Features
Texas Tech University Health Sciences Center	Master of Public Health (MPH)	▪ Health Promotion and Communication ▪ Generalist program	Resident: $217 Non-resident: $637	On-campus and online	• Public Administration (MPA/MPH) • Medicine (MD/MPH) • Pharmacy (PharmD/MPH)	▪ Students can choose between four alternative integrated learning experiences including a thesis, public health project, comprehensive exam, or capstone course.
The University of Texas at El Paso	Master of Public Health (MPH)	▪ Hispanic and Border Health	Resident: $519.75 Non-resident: $1,045	On-campus	--	▪ The program places a special emphasis on the promotion of health equity in Hispanic and border communities through the use of evidence-based approaches and the preparation of Hispanic health professionals.
The University of Texas Health Science Center at Houston	Master of Public Health (MPH)	▪ Customized specialization ▪ Community health practice ▪ Environmental health ▪ Epidemiology ▪ Health promotion & health education ▪ Health services organizations ▪ Healthcare management	Resident: $287 Non-resident: $1,075	On-campus and online	• Doctor of Jurisprudence (JD)/MPH • Master of Business Administration (MBA)/MPH • Medical Doctor (MD)/MPH • Master of Science (MS) in Biomedical Informatics/MPH • Master of Social Work (MSW)/MPH • Doctor of Philosophy (PhD) in Biomedical Informatics/ MPH	▪ The Master of Public Health (MPH) in Health Promotion/Health Education - Dietetic Internship allows students to further specialize in public health nutrition.

Sources: Institutional websites (see embedded hyperlinks)

.

PROGRAM BENCHMARKING

Benchmarked programs are offered by institutions located in the nation. Hanover selected half of programs based on their location in Texas and the rest from well performing distance programs in the country. Institutions are listed in alphabetical order.

Institution	Program	Concentrations	Per-credit Tuition	Delivery Mode	Dual Degrees Offered	Notable Features
University of Arizona	Master of Public Health (MPH)	Online and on-campus: ▪ Applied Epidemiology ▪ Health Behavior Health Promotion ▪ Health Services Administration On-campus only: ▪ Biostatistics ▪ Environmental and Occupational Health ▪ Global Health ▪ Family and Child Health ▪ One Health ▪ Public Health Policy and Management ▪ Public Health Practice	Resident: $908 Non-resident: $1,794 Online: $988	Online and on-campus	• MD/MPH • JD/MPH • PharmD/MPH • MPH/MBA • MPH/MA in Latin American Studies • MPH/MS in Mexican American Studies	▪ Global opportunities: Students can participate in study abroad programs tailored to public health or complete the program at a partner university in Ajman, United Arab Emirate
University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill	Master of Public Health (MPH)	Online and on-campus: ▪ Leadership ▪ Nutrition ▪ Applied epidemiology On-campus only: • Environmental Health Solutions • Global Health • Health Behavior • Health Equity, Social Justice And Human Rights • Health Policy • Maternal, Child And Family Health • Place-Based Health • Population Health For Clinicians • Public Health Data Science	$1,735	Online and on-campus	• JD/MPH • Master of City and Regional Planning (MCRP)/MPH • MSW/MPH • PharmD/MPH	▪ The MPH core curriculum has students work together and individually on semester-long projects, developing creative, research-based solutions for real-world public health problems.

Sources: Institutional websites (see embedded hyperlinks)

PROGRAM BENCHMARKING

Benchmarked programs are offered by institutions located in the nation. Hanover selected half of programs based on their location in Texas and the rest from well performing distance programs in the country. Institutions are listed in alphabetical order.

Institution	Program	Concentrations	Per-credit Tuition	Delivery Mode	Dual Degrees Offered	Notable Features
University of North Texas Health Science Center	Master of Public Health (MPH)	▪ Biostatistics and Data Science ▪ Epidemiology ▪ Maternal & Child Health ▪ Public Health Leadership (on-campus and online)	On-campus Rates*: Resident: $345 Non-resident: $893 Online Rates*: Resident: $321 Non-resident: $821	Online and On-campus	• DO/MPH - Doctor of Osteopathic Medicine and Master of Public Health • PA/MPH - Master of Physician Assistant Studies/Master of Public Health • PharmD/MPH - Doctor of Pharmacy/Master of Public Health • MS in Applied Anthropology/Master of Public Health	▪ Students are required to participate 4 hours of co-curricular programming each 8 week session. Events interlude opportunities in career preparation, cross-discipline collaboration and self-care programs.

Sources: Institutional websites (see embedded hyperlinks)
. *Note: Per credit rates calculated based on 42 credit hours and are rounded to the nearest dollar

HANOVER RESEARCH

CONTACT

Michael Lyons

Content Director, Higher Education

E: mlyons@hanoverresearch.com

P: 202-748-9971

hanoverresearch.com